

NOTE ON THE TRANSLATIONS

In order to make the Esher accounts as accessible as possible, all of them have been translated from the original (abbreviated) Latin into English. However, I have invariably kept three words in Latin, '*curia*', '*famuli*', and '*curallum*', the English equivalents for which are unsatisfactory. The '*curia*' effectively comprised the residential, administrative, and agricultural buildings at the heart of the manor; it is often translated simply as 'courtyard', but this does not do justice to the developing manorial complex at Esher. The '*famuli*' were workers on the demesne farm who were employed on a stipendiary basis. This group of ploughmen, carters, shepherds, dairymaids, and so on, can be translated as 'staff', 'permanent staff', or 'stipendiary workers', but these (to my mind) are either clumsy or anachronistic. '*Curallum*' is the poorest quality threshed grain; 'chaff', though, is too dismissive. On each occasion, these words, as with any non-English word, are printed in italics.

The conventions I have followed in translating the accounts are as follows. Personal names have been modernised but bynames or surnames have been left as in the original manuscript. Field names have also been given as they appear in the manuscript. Place names that are clearly identifiable have been rendered into modern English; but, if there is any doubt as to their identity, they have been left as written in the manuscript. Roman numerals in the manuscript have been replaced with Arabic numbers. For the sake of consistency, I have spelt out numbers below 10 unless they relate to livestock, the stock account, or to a measure of some sort. For clarity, marginal and textual headings and sum totals of groups of paragraphs are given in italics. Auditorial additions in the margins of the manuscript have been printed in the margins of the translation if possible (including calculations of yield ratios), but are otherwise contained in the footnotes. I have kept abbreviations to a minimum, only consistently using them for pounds (£), shillings (s), and pence (d). For convenience, I have converted every date that is given in terms of a saint's day into a modern calendar date, using C. R. Cheney's *Handbook of dates* and the online medieval calendar calculator, which can be found at <http://wallandbinkley.com/mcc/>. Many of the accounts contain scribal errors, which have been indicated in the translation.

Editorial interventions are as follows:

- \.../ Addition in superscript in the manuscript.
- ~~acra~~ Word '*acra*' crossed out in the manuscript.
- [...] Words or letters missing or illegible.
- [24 June] Editorial addition: usually to denote a date; but also if a sentence does not make sense without additional clarification (for example, if a word or unit is missing in the manuscript).
- New fol. Marginal note to indicate that, in the manuscript, the account resumes on the dorse of a membrane, or on a new membrane altogether.

For each of the translated accounts in this volume I have provided the precise manuscript reference, including the membrane(s) and the side of the membrane(s) on which it appears (thus, HRO, 11M59/B1/93, *rots* 22v, 23r for the account for 1340/1). However, in footnotes I refer either to the relevant document number in this volume (thus, doc. 32 for 1340/1) or, for those that are not published here, to the main reference for the Pipe Roll in which it is contained (thus, HRO, 11M59/B1/92 for 1339/40).